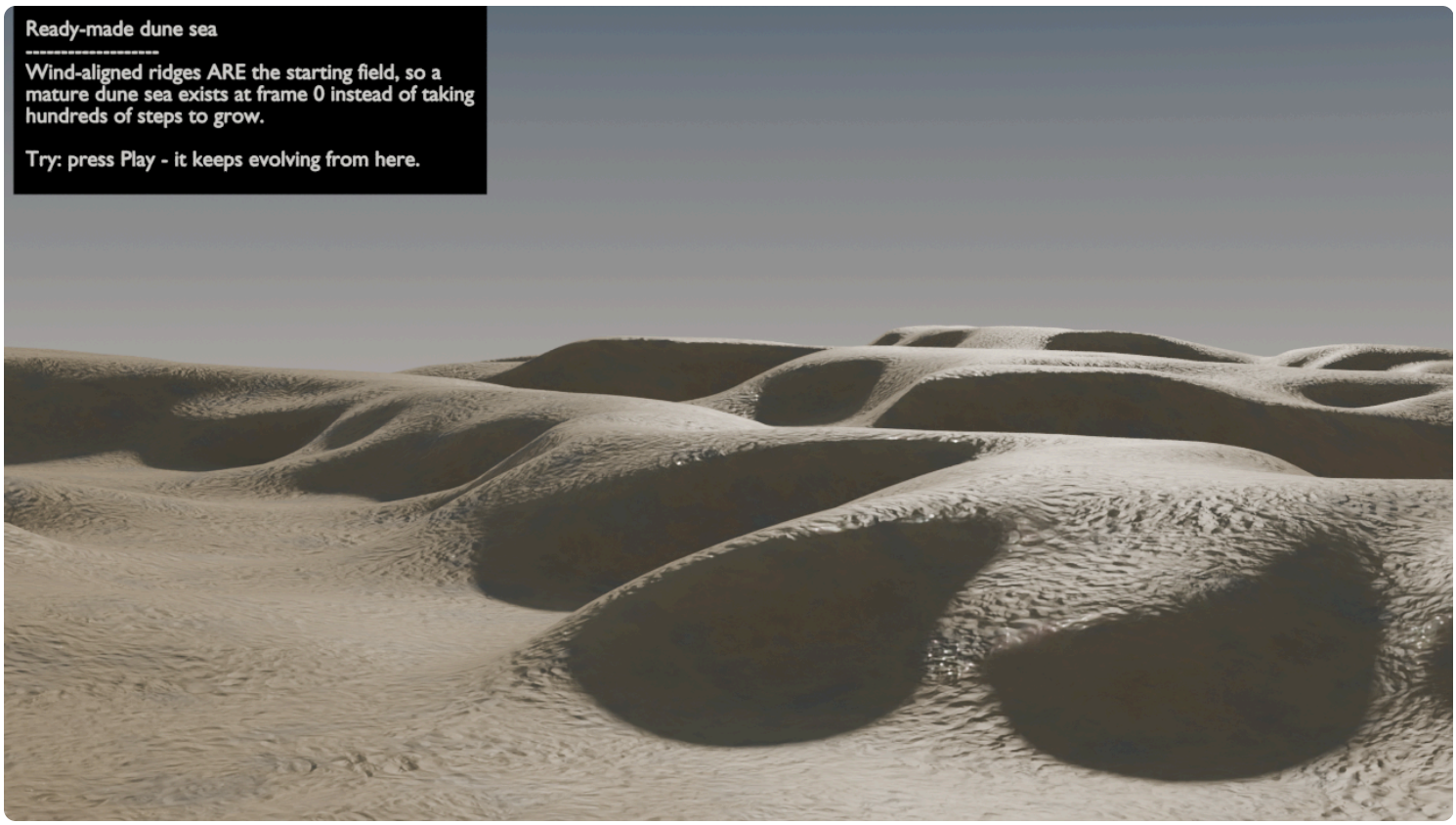
DunesForge - sand, dunes and snow in Blender

Create landscapes that respond to wind. Start with your own terrain or a built-in demo, place sand and explore evolving dunes, drifts and shores.



Store description

DunesForge is a Blender add-on for creating and evolving landscapes with loose sand and snow. Instead of sculpting every dune by hand, you set the terrain, material, wind and obstacles, then direct how the surface develops. Begin with a prepared example, your own heightmap or a regular grid mesh.

It suits scenes that combine natural forms with artistic control: dune fields, sand around rocks, snow along a fence, wet shores and patches stabilized by vegetation. Painted masks target important areas, while presets and demos provide practical starting points.

Problems it helps solve

- **Repetitive modelling:** wind and material transport create related forms across a surface.
- **Starting on custom terrain:** heightmap import and starting-sand painting work with your prepared landscape.
- **Hard-to-direct results:** wind direction, obstacles, masks and brushes provide local control.
- **Separate simulation and appearance:** field-aware materials help reveal dry or wet sand, snow and vegetation cover.
- **Too many controls at once:** Simple, Standard and Advanced expose tools progressively. Offline guides are available from the panel and individual settings.

Included

- Sand simulation and models for snow, water, moisture, vegetation and additional phenomena.
- Custom terrain from a heightmap or a suitable regular grid.
- Painting for starting sand, the live surface and supported masks.
- Materials, surface detail and visual airborne effects.
- Built-in demos and presets, including four large demonstrations over 400 m.
- Export, field-map saving and baking tools for the selected deliverable.

- A tutorial-based QuickStart, complete feature guide and installation guide as offline PDF manuals, in English and Polish.

Who it is for

Environment artists, shot creators, animators and material artists who want to explore terrain variations and refine them by hand. Technical artists gain access to masks, data and deeper process settings. Basic Blender navigation is useful; the tutorials do not require knowledge of solver equations.

Before you buy

DunesForge works on a regular heightfield. It is not a simulator for caves, overhangs or arbitrary volumes of granular material. Water uses a surface model rather than a full volumetric fluid solver. This is a scene-creation tool, not a certified geophysical prediction system.

The supported minimum is Blender 5.1; tested on Windows with Blender 5.1 to 5.4. Versions from 4.2 to 5.0 may work, but they have not been thoroughly tested. GPU acceleration uses CuPy/CUDA on compatible NVIDIA hardware. A slower CPU fallback is available. Larger grids, materials and effects need more memory; no fixed performance is promised for every computer.

The full distribution includes textures and is larger than the add-on code alone. Demos teach and demonstrate features; not every active process is equally visible in a single frame.

Short copy

One sentence: Create Blender dunes, sand around rocks and snow drifts with control over wind, terrain and painted masks.

Short description: DunesForge combines sand and snow simulation with artistic tools. Import your terrain, paint starting sand, set the wind and evolve the landscape. Begin with built-in demos, then explore masks, water, vegetation and export.

Presentation caption: From your own heightmap to a landscape that responds to wind. Explore the built-in demos and follow the QuickStart.